

THE FOREST RIGHTS ACT, 2006 (STATUTE)

Government of India · Act No. 2 of 2007 · Statutory Gazette Reference

CHAPTER I — PRELIMINARY & STATUTORY JURISDICTION

1. Short title and commencement: This Act may be called the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006. It extends to the whole of India.

2. Definitions & Vested Rights: '*Community Forest Resource*' means customary forest land within traditional boundaries of villages. '*Forest Dwelling Scheduled Tribes*' means members or communities who primarily reside in and depend on forests for bona fide livelihood needs.

CHAPTER II — RECOGNIZED FOREST RIGHTS FRAMEWORK

Section 3(1)(a) — Individual Forest Rights (IFR): Right to hold and live in the forest land under individual or common occupation for habitation or self-cultivation.

Section 3(1)(b) — Community Forest Rights (CFR): Community rights such as nistar, right of access to minor forest produce (MFP), grazing grounds, and seasonal water bodies.

Section 3(1)(i) — Conservation Authority: Right to protect, regenerate, conserve, or manage any community forest resource traditionally protected for sustainable use.

CHAPTER III — THREE-TIER STATUTORY VERIFICATION PROCESS

Gram Sabha (Village Level): Primary statutory authority to initiate the process for determining the nature and extent of individual and community forest rights.

Sub-Divisional Level Committee (SDLC): Reviews Gram Sabha resolutions and prepares draft records of forest rights.

District Level Committee (DLC): Final approving authority chaired by District Collector to grant and issue final Titles.